

DATA BRIEFING

Global CO₂ Emissions

Who Emits, How Much,
and What's Changing

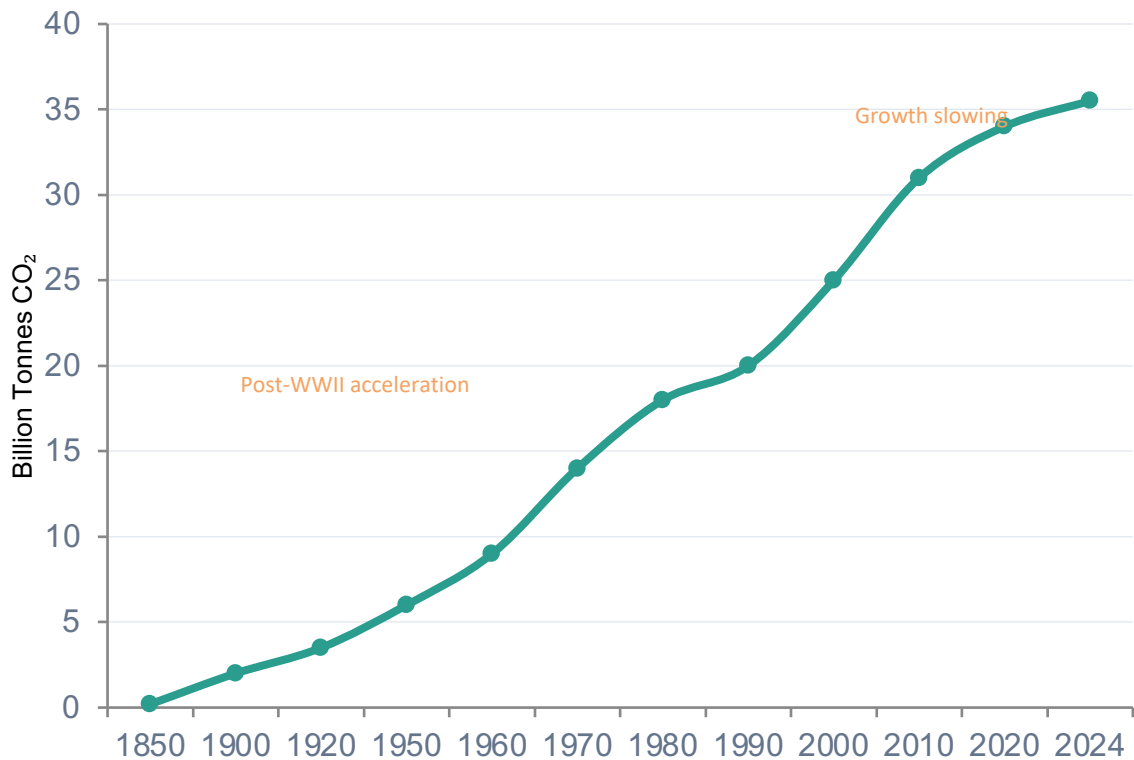
CO₂

Fossil Fuels & Industry · 1750–2024

Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

For policy analysts, climate negotiators, and sustainability researchers

Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



1950

~6 Bt

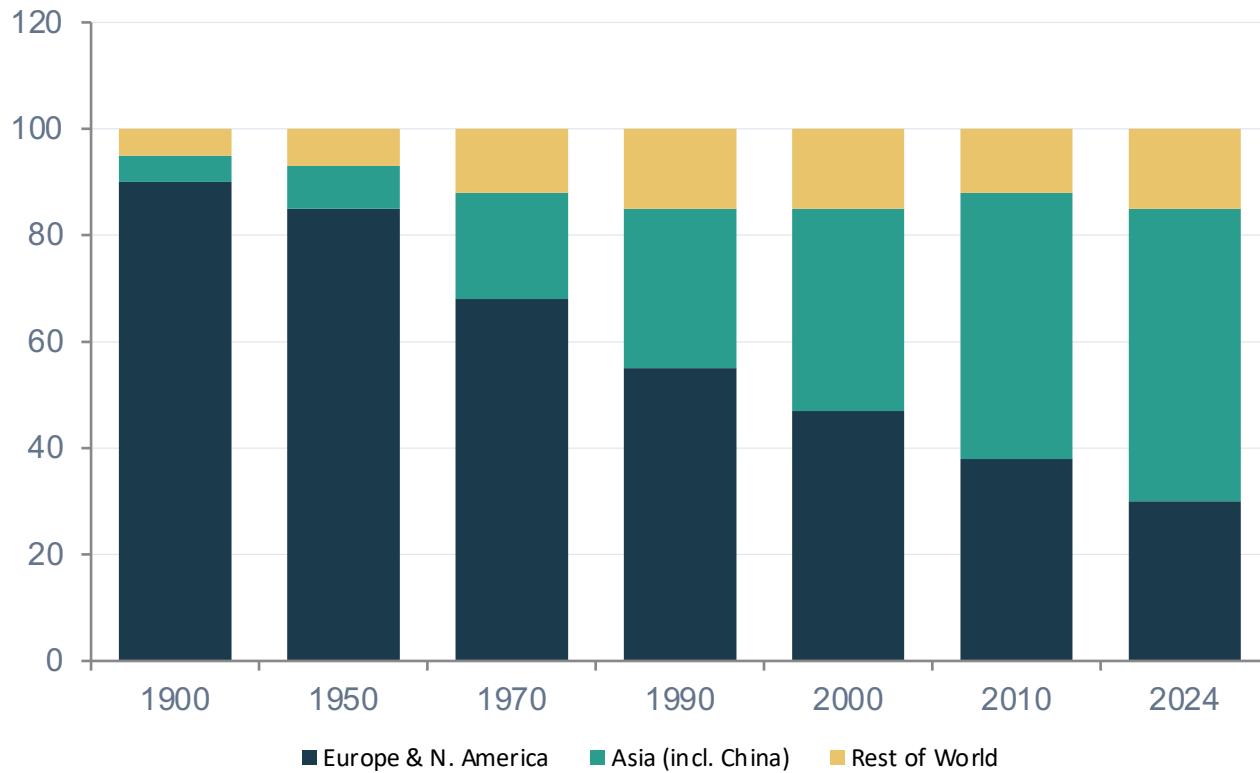
1990

~20 Bt

2024

>35 Bt

Europe & the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today



1900

90%+

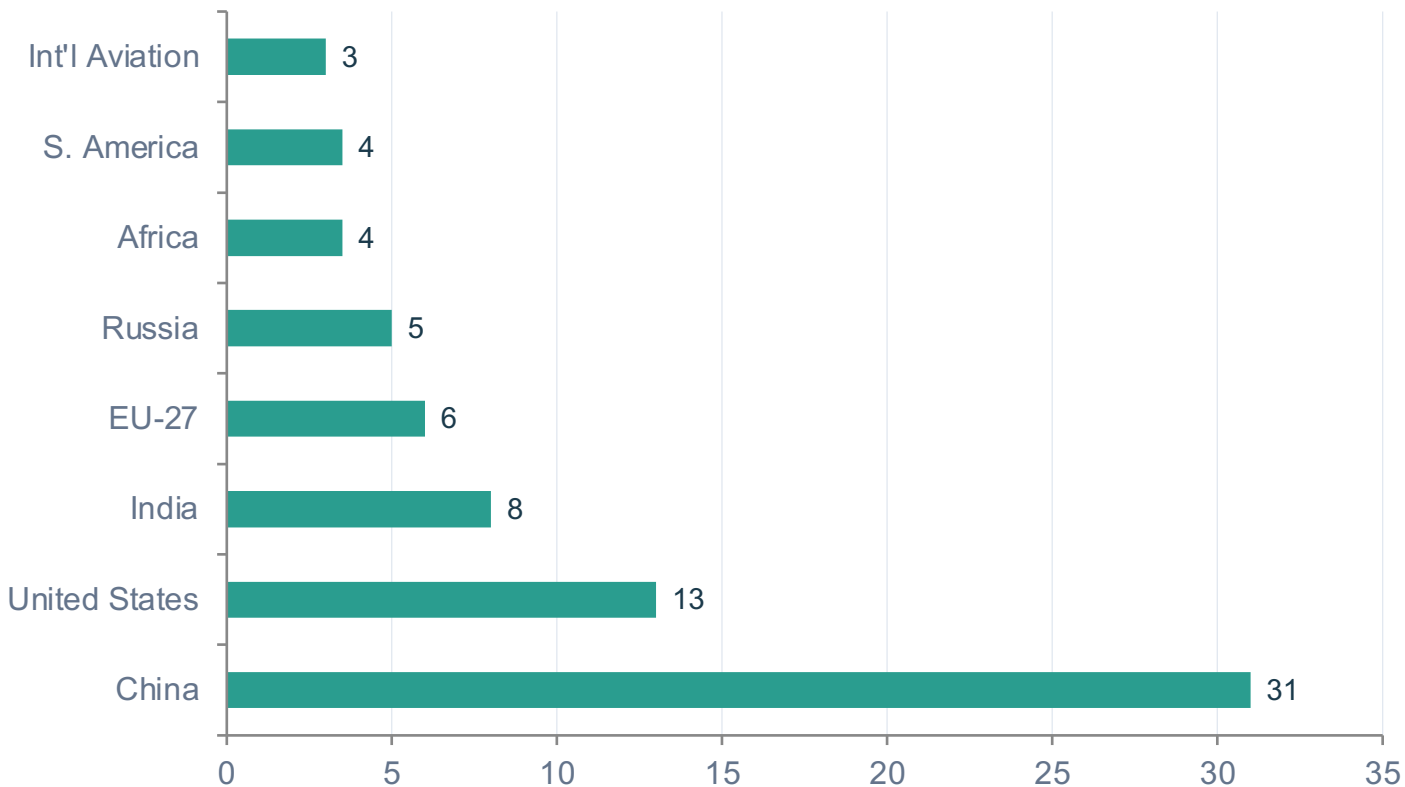
Europe & US share

2024

<33%

Europe & US share

China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂



CHINA

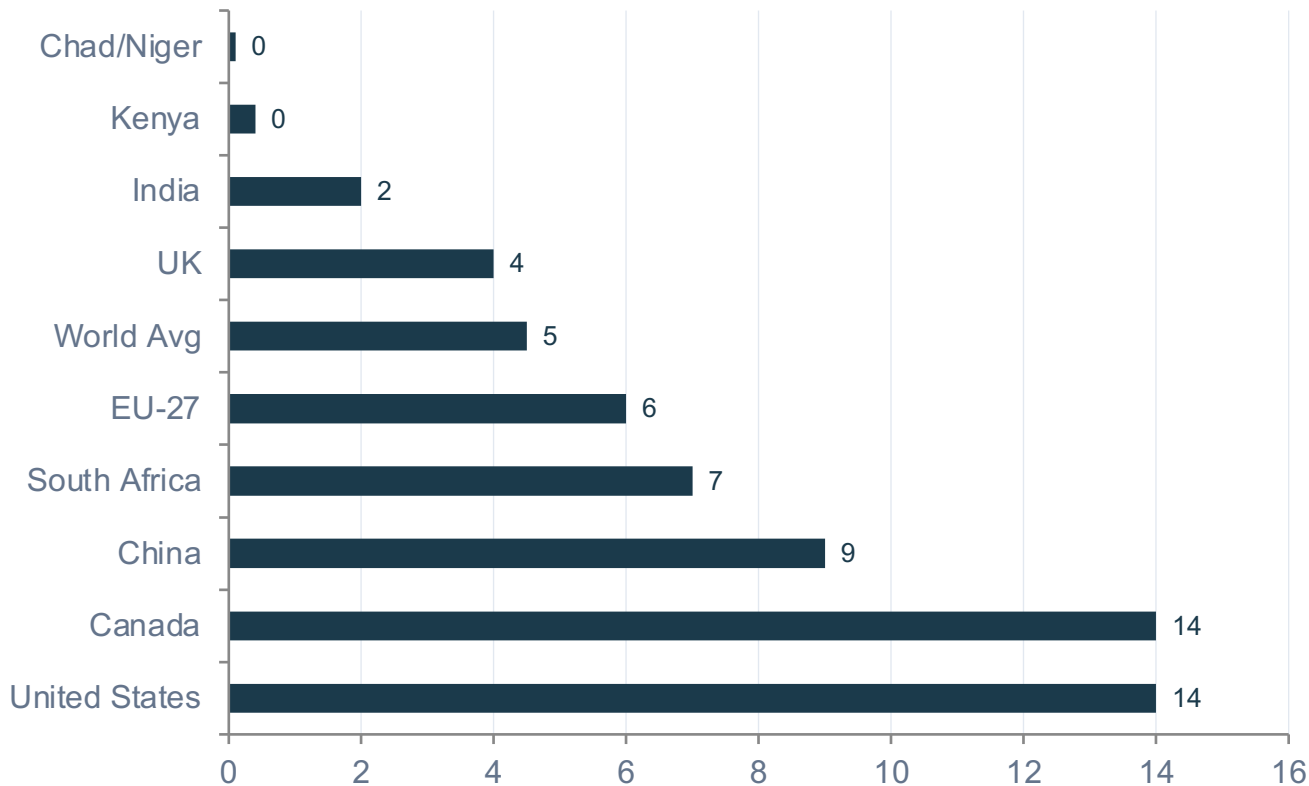
31%

of global CO₂

Trend:

Growth slowing but still rising

Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



150×

gap

US/Canada vs Chad

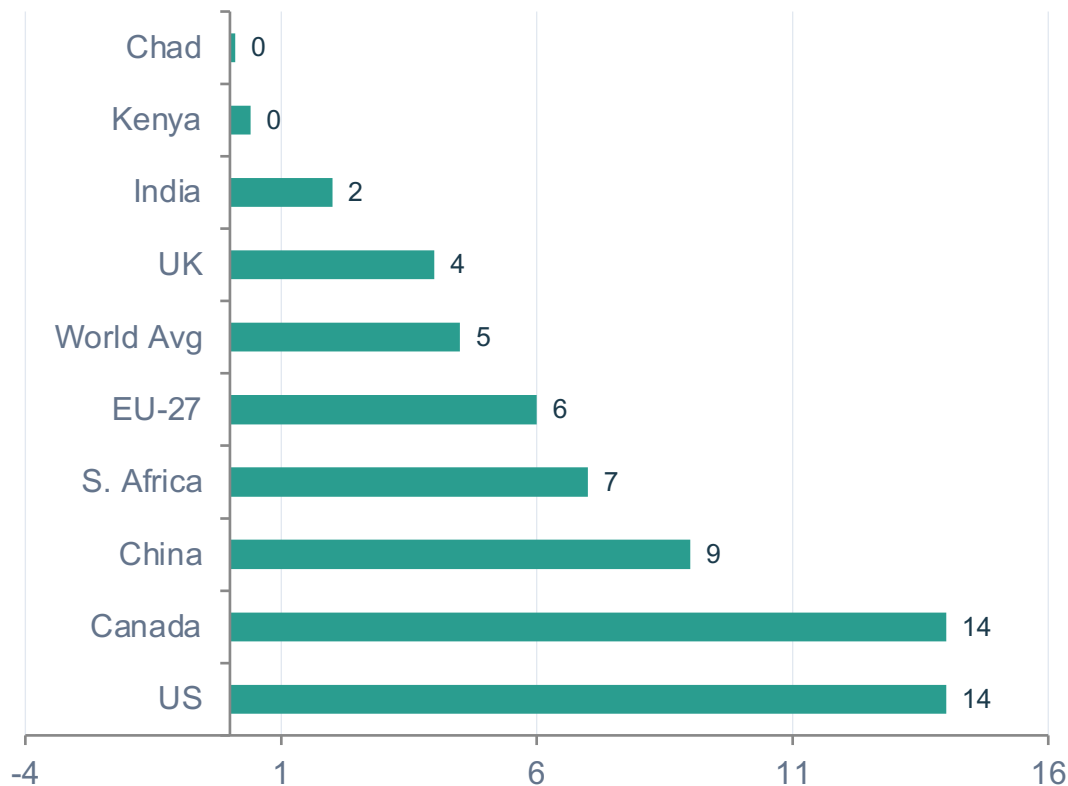
Energy Mix Matters

France & UK: ~4–6 t

Germany & US: ~14 t

Similar prosperity, very different carbon footprints

Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India



01

China emits 9 t/capita — below the US at 14 t, despite being the largest total emitter

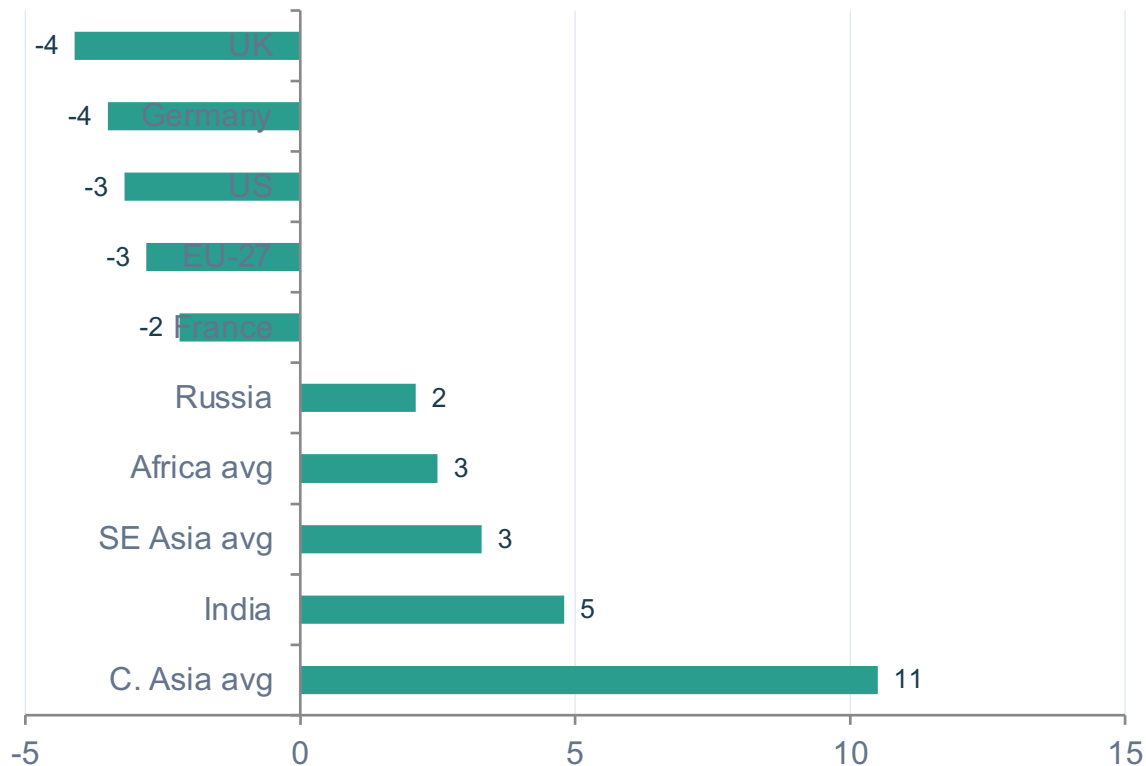
02

India at 2 t/capita remains well below the world average of 4.5 t

03

Historical trend: per capita emissions have risen in Asia while plateauing in Europe and North America

2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew



↓ Declining

US, EU-27, UK — reduced emissions in 2024 driven by renewables growth and efficiency gains

↑ Rising

Russia, SE Asia, parts of Africa and Central Asia saw increases; C. Asia >10% in some areas

Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US

Higher Per Capita

United States

~14 t / person

Fossil fuel-heavy grid

Germany

~9–10 t / person

Coal + gas dependency

VS

Lower Per Capita

France

~4–5 t / person

Nuclear-dominant grid

United Kingdom

~4 t / person

Renewables & nuclear

Key Insight:

Countries at similar prosperity levels can differ 3–4x in per capita emissions based on energy mix choices — nuclear and renewables sharply reduce carbon intensity.

CO₂

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Global Carbon Budget 2025
via Our World in Data

01

>35 Bt/yr and no peak yet — global emissions from fossil fuels continue rising

02

China is the largest annual emitter (~31%) but per capita emissions remain below the US

03

Historical responsibility dominated by Europe & US (>90% in 1900, now <33%)

04

150× per capita gap between richest emitters (~14 t) and poorest nations (~0.1 t)

05

Energy policy decouples prosperity from emissions — France & UK emit 3–4× less than Germany or the US